NxtWave Growth Challenge — 500 Registrations in 7 Days

PAGE 1: STRATEGY & ACQUISITION

Campaign: **"Build Your First AI Project in 60 Minutes"** | Practical Growth Plan & Asset Architecture

PRIMARY TARGET	SPRINT TIMELINE	BUDGET CEILING	TARGET AUDIENCE	CORE STRATEGY
500 Registrations	**7 Days (Sprint)**	**₹2,000 (Max Cap)**	**Final-Year Engineers**	**Permission Community + Referrals**

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Strategic Mission & Operational Foundation

Campaign Goal

Attract, validate, and onboard **500 final-year engineering students** into a free online workshop in 7 days, maintaining zero tolerance for spam or fabricated metrics.

Budget Discipline

Strict **₹2,000 total ceiling** prioritizing organic community distribution. Capital is allocated as an optional test and defensive reserve; unspent capital is preferred over wasteful spend.

Execution Paradigm

Permission-first distribution through verified WhatsApp groups, Class Representatives, and student clubs, reinforced by an attribution-tracked peer referral engine.

2. STUDENT UNDERSTANDING & AUDIENCE HYPOTHESES

Hypotheses to Validate (Not Concluded Research Findings)

Audience Dimension	Working Behavioral Hypothesis	Strategic Countermeasure on Landing Page & Messaging
Primary Motivation	Final-year engineers urgently need tangible technical projects to discuss during upcoming campus placements and off-campus recruitment rounds.	Positions a real, working project (*"AI Text Summarizer in ~45m"*) as the primary takeaway rather than theoretical slides or passive lectures.
Friction: Difficulty	Students fear AI requires advanced mathematics, neural network theory, or expensive GPU hardware setups they do not possess.	Clear prerequisite copy: *"No prior AI experience required. If you can write basic code in any language, you can build this."*
Friction: Time Commitment	Students juggle semester projects, lab exams, and placement training; standard 3-hour webinars face severe registration and attendance drop-offs.	Explicit 60-minute timebox guarantee prominently highlighted in the hero headline, syllabus breakdown, and confirmation page.
Friction: Upsell Skepticism	Students are saturated with "free masterclasses" that disguise aggressive sales pitches for expensive certificate courses.	High-trust disclosure: 100% free, zero hidden fees, zero unsolicited WhatsApp spam, and open-source starter code provided upfront.

3. PRIORITIZED ACQUISITION STRATEGY

Planning Hypothesis: Reconciled 500-Registration Target

Channel & Mechanism	Target	Share	Concrete Execution Action	Attribution & Tracking	Principal Risk & Governance
College WhatsApp Groups Direct cohort broadcast	**180**	36%	Request permission from group admins; share forwardable value cards with project previews.	`?utm_source=whatsapp` parameter parsed in backend.	Admin rejection or group broadcast fatigue. *Rule: Never post without admin approval.*
Class Representatives (CRs) Peer authority endorsement	**120**	24%	1:1 outreach to 25 target college CRs; provide ready-to-relay departmental notice copy.	`?utm_source=classrep` with college-specific tags.	Delayed CR follow-through. Mitigated by sharing ready-made 1-tap forwardable messages.
Tech Clubs & Coding Societies Pre-qualified tech enthusiasts	**90**	18%	Partner with college IEEE/ACM/GDSC leads to post in club Discord/WhatsApp channels.	`?utm_source=techclub` tracked in channel table.	Club governance approval cycles. Mitigated by highlighting purely non-commercial upskilling.
Student Peer Referrals K-factor viral multiplier	**70**	14%	Generate unique referral code on registration; encourage inviting project study partners.	`?ref=CODE` mapped to referrer's ID in SQLite.	Self-referral gaming. Mitigated by server-side email matching and unique deduplication.
Organic Technical Posts Intent-driven search & social	**40**	8%	Educational post: *"How to call your first LLM API in Python"* with registration link.	`?utm_source=organic` logged on landing page.	Platform algorithmic decay. Treated as an auxiliary channel with zero budget dependency.
Total Planned Hypothesis	**500**	**100%**	**Reconciled Sum: 180 + 120 + 90 + 70 + 40 = 500 registrations across 5 distinct channels.**		

4. BUDGET ALLOCATION PLAN (STRICT ₹2,000 TOTAL CEILING)

Planned Expenditure Hypotheses (Not Incurred Expenses)

₹1,000 — 50% | Optional Paid Test

Micro-Paid Pilot: Highly targeted Meta/Campus pilot (only deployed if an approved, measurable paid channel exists and organic Day 3 conversion confirms CAC ≤ ₹15).

₹500 — 25% | Creative Assets

Asset Contingency: Formatted forwardable flyer cards, project architectural diagrams, and mobile-optimized visual collateral for community distribution.

₹500 — 25% | Defensive Reserve

Defensive Buffer: Strictly unallocated reserve. Deployed only to double down on the top-performing permitted organic channel; otherwise retained unspent.

Capital Efficiency Principle: Organic community distribution is prioritized. ₹2,000 is an operational ceiling, not a spending mandate. Retaining unspent capital is superior to unmeasured, low-intent paid customer acquisition.

NxtWave Growth Challenge — Execution & Working Asset

Operational Roadmap, Telemetry Architecture, Risk Governance, and Pre-Registered Experimentation

5. SEVEN-DAY OPERATIONAL EXECUTION CALENDAR

Sequential Tactical Sprint

DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Asset Finalization Launch landing page, SQLite schema, UTM logging, referral engine. Prepare permission request copy.	**Campus Directory** Map 25 target colleges; contact Class Representatives & Club Leads; secure explicit posting permission.	**Approved Launch** Deploy tracked links across permitted WhatsApp groups. Monitor real-time server health & rate limits.	**Velocity Audit** Audit channel acquisition against targets in Growth Dashboard; refine messaging for lagging college cohorts.	**Referral Push** Trigger referral prompt to registered students; showcase project preview (Text Summarizer architecture).	**Objection Clearing** Deploy permitted reminder clarifying zero AI prerequisites and 60-min timebox; resolve student queries.	**Final Operations** Final 6-hour permitted reminder; close intake; export sanitized CSV ledger for attendee onboarding.

6. MEASUREMENT FRAMEWORK & DECISION GOVERNANCE

Truthful Denominators & Daily Reallocation Protocol

Telemetry & Guardrail Metrics

- **Primary KPI:** Verified registrations stored in SQLite against the 500-seat ceiling.
- **Channel Contribution:** Tracked via `bySource` aggregation against planned quotas.
- **Conversion Rate (CR%):** Calculated *strictly when valid visit impression denominators exist.*
- **Cost Per Acquisition (CAC):** Calculated *strictly against actual disbursed ad spend.*

Daily Reallocation Protocol

- **Daily 18:00 IST Audit:** Compare channel registration run-rates against the ~72/day baseline.
- **Underperformance Rule:** If a channel is >30% below pace by Day 4, outreach effort is reallocated to high-converting CRs.
- **Zero Fabricated Metrics:** No decorative counters or arbitrary multipliers.

7. WORKING ASSET: GROWTH PROTOTYPE SPECIFICATION

Fully Operational Local Web Application Supporting Strategy

Prototype Module	Verified Technical Implementation	Strategic Growth Role
Landing Page (`/`)	Tailwind v4 responsive interface; clear 60-min outcome; project blueprint; FAQ; ethical prototype disclosure.	High-converting, low-friction acquisition gateway eliminating student skepticism.
Registration Engine (`/register`)	React Hook Form + Zod validation; SQLite normalized email deduplication; UTM & referral parsing.	Guarantees data cleanliness and prevents duplicate or automated spam submissions.
Referral Hub (`/success`)	Generates unique Registration ID (`WS-XXXXXX`) and readable referral code with 1-click clipboard link builder.	Powers the 70-registration viral loop target through friction-free peer sharing.
Growth Dashboard (`/dashboard`)	Live KPI cards, 500-target progress bar, Recharts velocity & channel graphs, editable channel targets, safe CSV export.	Provides executive visibility, attribution tracking, and operations handoff.
Data Mode Separation	Explicit toggle separating genuine local registrations (`is_demo = 0`) from synthetic records (`is_demo = 1`).	Guarantees demonstration transparency; demo data never pollutes live records.

Asset Disclosure: The working prototype is an operational measurement and workflow tool built to support this challenge. It demonstrates technical readiness; it is not proof that 500 live registrations currently exist.

8. STRATEGIC RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

Defensive Risk Management

Limited Organic Reach & Admin Gatekeeping

Risk: WhatsApp group admins refuse promotional posts.
Mitigation: Pitch as non-commercial academic upskilling; provide co-branding recognition for participating student coding clubs.

Attribution Leakage & Direct Drift

Risk: Students strip UTM tags when forwarding links.
Mitigation: Pre-shorten links with baked-in parameters; utilize unique student referral codes as a persistent secondary attribution layer.

Landing Page Form Abandonment

Risk: Visitors bounce when encountering long registration fields.
Mitigation: Constrain form strictly to 5 essential academic fields; provide immediate visual confirmation without email verification barriers.

Spreadsheet Formula Injection Vulnerability

Risk: Malicious student input executes DDE commands in Excel exports.
Mitigation: Automatic sanitization prefixing formula triggers (`=, +, -, @`) with single quotes in the CSV export engine.

9. PRE-REGISTERED GROWTH EXPERIMENTS

Planned Methodological Tests (Not Claimed as Completed)

EXP-01: Headline Framing

Project Outcome vs. Abstract Skill

Hypothesis: "Build an AI App in 60m" converts higher than "Learn AI Fundamentals" due to placement portfolio demand.

Metric: Landing Page CR% (min. 150 visits/variant).

Decision: Adopt if outcome variant ≥ 15% lift ($p < 0.05$).

EXP-02: Message Format

Finished Preview vs. Syllabus Bullets

Hypothesis: Visual card showing the finished Text Summarizer drives higher CTR in class groups than text-heavy syllabus points.

Metric: Tracked UTM link CTR & completed registrations.

Decision: Standardize if visual card ≥ 25% lift across 10 groups.

EXP-03: Referral Incentive

Study Partner vs. Generic Share

Hypothesis: "Invite a Project Partner to Build Together" yields higher viral factor than generic "Invite Friends".

Metric: Referral coefficient (k-factor = referral regs / initial regs).

Decision: Prioritize referral modal if $k > 0.20$ on Day 5.